

Psalms 54

Save Me by Thy Name

Save me, O God, by thy name

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *Save me, O God, by thy name, and judge me by thy strength.*
- 2 *Hear my prayer, O God; give ear to the words of my mouth.*
- 3 *For strangers are risen up against me, and oppressors seek after my soul: they have not set God before them. Selah.*
- 4 *Behold, God is mine helper: the Lord is with them that uphold my soul.*
- 5 *He shall reward evil unto mine enemies: cut them off in thy truth.*
- 6 *I will freely sacrifice unto thee: I will praise thy name, O LORD; for it is good.*
- 7 *For he hath delivered me out of all trouble: and mine eye hath seen his desire upon mine enemies.*

2 · CONTEXT

Superscription ties this to the Ziphites who betrayed David's hiding place to Saul (1 Sam 23:19; 26:1). It is a short, urgent psalm of a man surrounded by treacherous informants, moving quickly from plea to praise. Henry highlights that David appeals to God's "name"—His revealed character—rather than to his own merit or strength.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-3

"Save me, O God, by thy name... strangers are risen up against me, and oppressors seek after my soul." Betrayal by supposed countrymen who "have not set God before them" is the crisis; the plea rests entirely on who God is, not on David's cause.

Verse 4-5

Confidence follows swiftly: "Behold, God is mine helper: the Lord is with them that uphold my soul." David asks God to "reward evil unto mine enemies" in His truth—entrusting justice to God rather than taking it himself.

Verse 6-7

He vows a freewill offering and promises to praise God's name, "for it is good," because his eye "hath seen his desire upon mine enemies"—deliverance already realized in confident anticipation.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

When surrounded by betrayal, the ground for hope is God's own name and character, not personal innocence or strength. Prayer here moves rapidly from crisis to certainty of help, modeling how quickly trust can turn desperation into praise.

Application for life today.

When people you expected to be safe betray or expose you, appeal to who God is rather than rehearsing the injustice. Let vows of thanksgiving be made even while still waiting on deliverance, as an act of faith. Leave repayment of evildoers to God's justice rather than orchestrating it yourself.

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no "right length" answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. Who has played the role of the "Ziphites" in your life, and how does this psalm shape your response to them?

2. What does it mean practically to "save me... by thy name" rather than by your own strategy or strength?

3. How quickly do you move from crisis to praise, and what would help you trust God's help more readily?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).